

Model of Engagement

1. INFORM (Lowest Level of Engagement)

Definition

Providing **information to the community** so they understand an issue, decision, or project.

Key Characteristics

- One-way communication
- No feedback required
- Community has **no role in decision-making**

Tools & Methods

- Posters
- Social media announcements
- TV/radio messages
- Public notices

Example (Pakistan)

- Government awareness campaigns about **dengue prevention**
- COVID-19 SOPs shared through media

Advantages

- Quick and cost-effective
- Useful in emergencies

Limitations

- No community participation
 - People may ignore or misunderstand information
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2. CONSULT

Definition

Seeking **opinions, feedback, or suggestions** from the community.

Key Characteristics

- Two-way communication (limited)
- Final decision still made by authorities

Tools & Methods

- Surveys
- Public meetings
- Interviews
- Feedback forms

Example

- Education departments taking feedback from teachers and parents
- Local government asking citizens about development priorities

Advantages

- Community feels heard
- Better decision-making

Limitations

- Feedback may not be used
 - Can create frustration if ignored
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3. INVOLVE

Definition

Working **directly with the community** during planning and implementation.

Key Characteristics

- Active participation
- Community input is considered
- Shared responsibility (partial)

Tools & Methods

- Workshops
- Focus groups
- Community meetings
- Participatory planning

Example

- The Citizens Foundation
 - Involves parents in school management
- Local communities helping design water supply systems

Advantages

- Builds trust
- Better solutions

Limitations

- Time-consuming
 - Requires coordination
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4. COLLABORATE

Definition

A **partnership** where community and organizations **share decision-making power**.

Key Characteristics

- Strong two-way communication
- Joint planning and implementation
- Shared responsibility

Tools & Methods

- Joint committees
- Partnerships (NGOs + community)
- Co-management systems

Example

- National Rural Support Programme
 - Works with village organizations for development
- NGOs working with communities on sanitation and education projects

Advantages

- High trust and ownership
- Sustainable outcomes

Limitations

- Requires strong coordination
 - Possible conflicts between stakeholders
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5. EMPOWER (Highest Level of Engagement)

Definition

Giving full decision-making power to the community.

Key Characteristics

- Community controls decisions
- Authorities act as facilitators
- Maximum participation

Tools & Methods

- Community-led organizations
- Local committees managing funds
- Self-governance

Example

- Akhuwat Foundation
 - Communities manage loan distribution
- Village committees deciding development priorities

Advantages

- Strong ownership
- Long-term sustainability
- Builds leadership

Limitations

- Requires capacity building
- Risk of mismanagement if training is lacking